But the rumours, largely the work of envious and disgruntled elements, did not cease despite the fact that each run enabled the bank to emerge from the ordeal stronger and more confident. It also became obvious to impartial observers that the runs were being engineered by interested parties and brought forth public appreciation of the Central Bank's work and condemnation of the campaign against it. The absorption of the TIB in 1923 gave another opportunity to the enemies of the bank to work their mischief. Certain shareholders started frivolous legal proceedings against it and in 1923–24 the Calcutta branch of the Central Bank was the target of one of the most serious runs the bank had faced. In Calcutta, on one day alone, ₹1 crore was paid out and the crowd of depositors showed no sign of dispersing. The crisis mutated into the perfect storm. In Bombay and Calcutta crores of rupees were paid over the counter overnight and the staff worked continuously for two days. But the deposits returned almost as quickly once the bank's ability to pay had registered. It was also to the great credit of the Calcutta branch of the bank that it was able to cope without any direct assistance from the head office considering that at one point it was paying out ₹50 lakhs per day.

Notices were issued to assure the people that the Central Bank would remain open until midnight, or later, if required by the depositors. 'A special statement drafted by Sorabji appeared in the *Amrita Bazaar Patrika* and this, together with payment to the last nervous depositor turned the tide and the majority of those who had so frenziedly withdrawn their money returned to pay it back.'[18] The response of the bank drew high words of praise from Sir Basil Blackett, the Finance Member, who remarked: 'It was a great tribute to the strength and soundness of the institution that this well organized storm has been checked in so triumphant a manner, and he 'hoped that those who are organizing the malicious attacks would feel that it is a waste of their time because they are useless.'[19]

The voice of admonition had barely died down when the Central Bank faced more trouble. In the course of two brief days, in August 1925, the bank stood a run of ₹2 crores and more. This run had a curious origin. Some merchants lost heavily in sugar and wool and were on the point of bankruptcy. Among them, one bore the name Ajam which was also the name of one of the Directors of the Central Bank. On this flimsy ground, the bank's detractors created a scare in the Zaveri Bazaar in Bombay. This